

Monitors in March

56 monitors, 4 reviewers, 20 days, and hours of hardwork. Digit team invents innovative ways to keep their sanity as they bring you India's first LCD test

The Digital Media Research and Test Centre (DMRTC), which tests new hardware and software for Digit every month, had a

'mighty' March surprise—a test of 56 monitors in less than 20 days.

The Test Centre was humming with activity. Ali, Ashu and Mitul—the reviewers were grappling with the task of testing the monitors, while Yatish grappled with 21 graphics cards (we had to drop this section, you should have seen his face when he was told this). And then there were products to be tested for the Bazaar section.

The DMRTC fell to the same old routine: put in extra hours, pop in early, leave late in the night, live on junk food and cola. Out of extreme circumstances arose

innovation. Mitul turned crooner and started singing to keep himself (and others) alert through the strenuous testing process. Pretty soon, the camaraderie turned to war-

at Rs 80,000. The Test Centre guys, not missing the slightest of detail, calculated that each kilogram of the monitor cost approximately Rs 2,300.

Slim beauties (LCDs) made the task of going over stats much more interesting. The Geometry test (comprising the Pincushion and Barrel distortion test, Local Regulation test and so on), documenting scores for Screen Pixel Resolution and other tests went like a breeze.

Smiles, songs and fun ended when it was time to bid adios to the monitors. Cladding the matronly CRTs in their brown boxes was a test of muscles. All those huge

chunks of polystyrene foam had to be placed in the right way and

then, the CRTs heave-hoed into the box....

It made many smile to see the unusually gung-ho gang of reviewers, who sail through all the complex testing processes, suddenly fumble trying to figure out what went in where. Tsk, tsk. ■



ILLUSTRATION: Mahesh Benkar

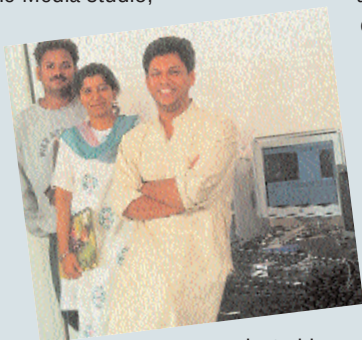
bling. The auditory treat ranged from the very current 'Aslam bhai' to the hip and happening numbers by Shakira.

There were some other high points in the testing process. One of the monitors tipped the scales at 35 kgs and was priced

Lights, Camera, Action!

The pressure and accompanying pleasure of triumph only happens when working under deadlines. It's a part of the working of the Media Studio, what with the behind-the-scenes activities like writing and rewriting scripts, shooting sequences, editing, etc, none of which is easy.

The recent CTO Forum held by Jasubhai Digital Media tested our Studio brethren to their limits. Right from the word go, the pace of work could be



described aptly in just one word: 'frenzied'. Bimal, Priya, Prashant and Afzal, the pillars of the Studio, scouted all around Mumbai and Delhi, shooting for the event. The studio resembled a modern day war room: ringing phones, heated discussions and all the accompanying action that happens in crunch time. However, the team insisted on quality above all else and kept rejecting scripts for the film; between eight and 10 scripts were rejected because they all missed that essential *something*.

Sleep and food, the two elements that help keep the mind, body and soul together were forgotten. But Prashant took charge and saw to it that there weren't any casualties due to starvation. Afzal, of course, worked as a reality checker. He would give realistic estimates of the time required to finish any particular piece of work, exhorting his colleagues to abandon their over-optimistic estimates.

But in spite of all the hurdles, our stalwarts didn't buckle an inch. After the angst and the agony, the film was extremely well made and ready on time. Appreciation for the film poured in from all quarters when it was screened at the CTO Forum. As a certain author would say, all's well that ends well.